

vocational classrooms, libraries, laundry rooms, cafeterias, kitchens, and administrative offices.

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See also: [Alcatraz](#); [Angola](#); [Attica](#); [Custody Levels](#); [Environmentally Friendly \(“Green”\) Prisons](#); [Florence ADX](#); [Inmate Classification](#); [Jails Compared to Prisons](#); [Juvenile Detention Centers](#); [Leavenworth](#); [Maximum Security](#); [Panopticon](#); [Prisons, History of](#); [San Quentin](#); [Solitary Confinement](#); [Visitation](#)

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## Angola

The term “Angola” is a nickname under which the Louisiana State Penitentiary is known because countless slaves in the United States of America came from Angola in Africa. Angola, also known as “The Farm,” is the largest maximum security prison in the United States. Given that the prison is the only maximum security facility in Louisiana, it houses inmates convicted of the most serious and violent crimes. Hence, the majority of inmates in Angola have a life sentence, and the facility is also the location of the execution chamber for death row inmates. Although only the condemned men are housed in Angola, the prison carries out executions for both male and female inmates who have been sentenced to death. Due to the high number of aging inmates who will never be released, a hospice program was introduced in the prison in 1998. Two years after the launch of the program, Angola Hospice Chapel was established, which allowed for the inmates to have formal funerals on the prison grounds. In relation to general medical care, a medical center for various inpatient services is available; nonetheless, the inmates with serious medical issues or those who are in need of surgery must be transferred elsewhere. Apart from medical services, a variety of educational and rehabilitative programs are offered at Angola. For example, inmates may learn a trade such as eyeglass repair or participate in a prerelease exit program.

Angola is best known because of its presence in the media mainly due to its penal tourism activities and activism. Since 2001, Louisiana State Penitentiary hosts an Arts and Crafts Festival where inmates with a good record can present and sell the goods that they have created through obtaining craft materials sold by prison-approved vendors. The customers cannot pay the inmates directly, and only a few trustee inmates are allowed to participate in the event without being restricted by bars. Inmate bands also perform at the festival. The event happens during one weekend in spring and every Sunday in October each year. Another significant event takes place during the Arts and Crafts Festival, which is the Angola Prison Rodeo. This is one of the most controversial and famous prison events happening in the United States; however, its purpose is to serve as a positive influence on rehabilitation and reform of the inmates, as specified in the Angola Prison Rodeo Charter. Inmates who choose to participate in the rodeo are financially rewarded whenever they win. Using proper judges has professionalized the rodeo. Nevertheless, the rodeo has gained unwanted attention because participating inmates are not provided with any training; hence, the event is potentially dangerous to them. Additionally, some researchers argue that the rodeo is humiliating and reinforces the inmates’ “outsider” status within American society. The prison rodeo has a longer history than the festival, as it was first held in 1965, but it was not open to the public until 1967. The capacity of the rodeo venue is 11,000 visitors, and each ticket costs \$20 as of 2016. The proceeds from all of the above-mentioned events go toward the Inmate Welfare Fund, which is meant to cover activities that improve the prison conditions. Louisiana State Penitentiary also partakes in another penal tourism activity where, for \$10, members of the public may choose to play golf in the penitentiary’s Prison View Golf Course that overlooks parts of the facility. Nonetheless, guests must go through a background check before they are able to play. A museum of Louisiana’s prisons within Angola was established in 1998. Admission to the museum is free, and the gift shop offers items such as clothing with the phrase “Angola—A Gated Community” printed on them.

A significant example of activism is inmates’ editing and publishing *The Angolite*, which is a nationally recognized prison news magazine. The annual subscription cost is \$20 for the public. The magazine used to be coedited by two of Angola’s most notable inmates, Billy Wayne Sinclair and Wilbert Rideau, who were both

initially sentenced to death. Sinclair coauthored a memoir, *A Life in the Balance: The Billy Wayne Sinclair Story, A Journey from Murder to Redemption Inside America's Worst Prison System*, with his wife in 2012, six years after his release. Rideau continued working in the media upon his release in 2005 and was presented with the George Polk Award in Journalism in 2011. A well-received documentary movie about the prison from 1998, *The Farm: Angola, USA*, was codirected by Rideau.

Angola has also been featured in the media because of Sister Helen Prejean, who wrote the book *Dead Man Walking: The Eyewitness Account of the Death Penalty That Sparked a National Debate*, which portrayed her spiritual advisory of two men on death row in Angola—Elmo Patrick Sonnier and Robert Lee Willie. Both of these inmates were electrocuted in Angola in the 1980s. The book was later made into a movie directed by Tim Robbins and starring Sean Penn and Susan Sarandon, who won an Oscar for her portrayal of Sister Helen Prejean. *Dead Man Walking* was adapted into an opera in 2000 and has recently been introduced as a possible literary curriculum for high school students to promote awareness of the death penalty. Sister Prejean is still involved with Angola and continues to provide spiritual services to death row inmates.

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See also: [Death Row Inmates](#); [Maximum Security](#); [Prison Industries](#); [Prison Museums](#)

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## Antiterrorism and Effective Death Penalty Act of 1996

The Antiterrorism and Effective Death Penalty Act (AEDPA) of 1996 was introduced by the Senate majority leader at the time, Senator Bob Dole, in the aftermath of the 1993 World Trade Center bombing and the 1995 Oklahoma City federal building bombing. President Bill Clinton signed it into law on April 24, 1996. The purpose of the act, as stated in the bill summary, was to “deter terrorism, provide justice for victims, [and to] provide for an effective death penalty.”

The act had many provisions to fulfill its stated purpose. Title I concerns habeas corpus reform. Title II concerns providing restitution or assistance to victims of terrorism, while Title III refers to the designation of foreign terrorist organizations and prohibitions on providing funding to them. Title IV discusses the removal or exclusion of